



What to Know When Patient Says, “I Have Diarrhea.”

Acute Gastroenteritis:

Viral Pathogens (50 to 70%)

- Norovirus is the leading cause of gastroenteritis among people of all ages
- Other common viral pathogens are rotavirus, enteric adenovirus, and astrovirus

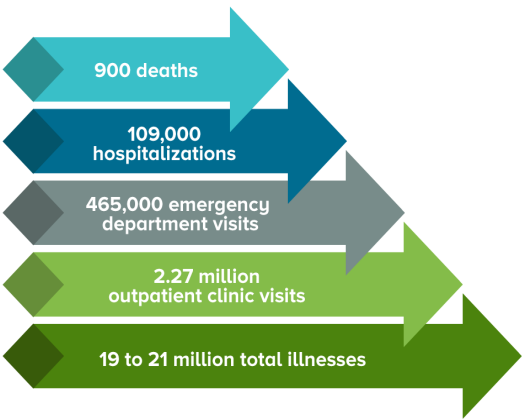
Bacteria (15 to 20%)

- Staphylococcus aureus, Campylobacter jejuni, Shigella, Salmonella, Yersinia, and Escherichia coli

Parasites (10 to 15%)

- Giardia and Cryptosporidium

Annual Impact of Norovirus



Diagnosis & Evaluation

Routine Laboratory and Stool Studies are Not Required

What To Order	When:
BACTERIAL GI PANEL (SALMONELLA, SHIGELLA/EIEC, CAMPYLOBACTER, SHIGA TOXIN DNA), STOOL, MULTIPLEX PCR 87505A	- Severe illness (profuse watery diarrhea, signs of hypovolemia, passage of ≥6 unformed stools per 24 hours, severe abdominal pain, need for hospitalization) - Features of inflammatory diarrhea (bloody diarrhea, small volume mucous stools, fever) - High-risk host features (e.g., age ≥70 years, cardiac disease, immunocompromising condition, inflammatory bowel disease, pregnancy) - Symptoms persisting for more than one week - Public health concerns (e.g., diarrheal illness in food handlers, health care workers, and individuals in day care centers)
O AND P IDENTIFICATION [87177C]	- A recent history of international travel - Camping, hiking or backpacking in the mountains
CLOSTRIDIUM DIFFICILE ANTIGEN AND TOXINS A AND B W REFLEX TO PCR [231607].	- Currently taking antibiotics - History of antibiotics within the past three months - Hospitalized within the past three months

Treatment

Acute viral gastroenteritis is usually self-limited and is treated with supportive measures

- Adequate fluid repletion is the mainstay of treatment
- Antiemetic as needed for one to two days to facilitate oral fluid repletion
- Empiric use of antibiotics is NOT recommended

Pediatric Corner

Increased stool frequency with loose consistency with or without vomiting, fever, or abdominal pain.

Examples of increased stool frequency include:

- ≥3 loose or watery stools in 24 hours
- Number of loose/watery bowel movements that exceeds the child's usual number of daily bowel movements by two or more



TABLE 3

Clinical Dehydration Scale

Characteristic	0 points	1 point	2 points
Appearance	Normal	Thirsty, restless, or lethargic but irritable when touched	Drowsy, limp, cold, sweaty, comatose
Eyes	Normal	Slightly sunken	Very sunken
Mucous membranes	Moist	Sticky	Dry
Tears	Tears	Decreased tears	Absent tears

Scoring: 0 points = less than 3% dehydration; 1 to 4 points = mild (3% to 6%) dehydration; 5 to 8 points = moderate to severe (more than 6%) dehydration. Information from reference 16.

Please refer to clinical guidelines in the Pediatric Virtual Playbook for Pediatric Patients:

<https://sp-cloud.kp.org/sites/VMCSCALPeds/SitePages/Vomiting-and-Diarrhea---Pediatric-Virtual-Playbook.aspx>

https://www.aafp.org/content/dam/brand/aafp/pubs/afp/issues/2019/0201/p159-t3.gif